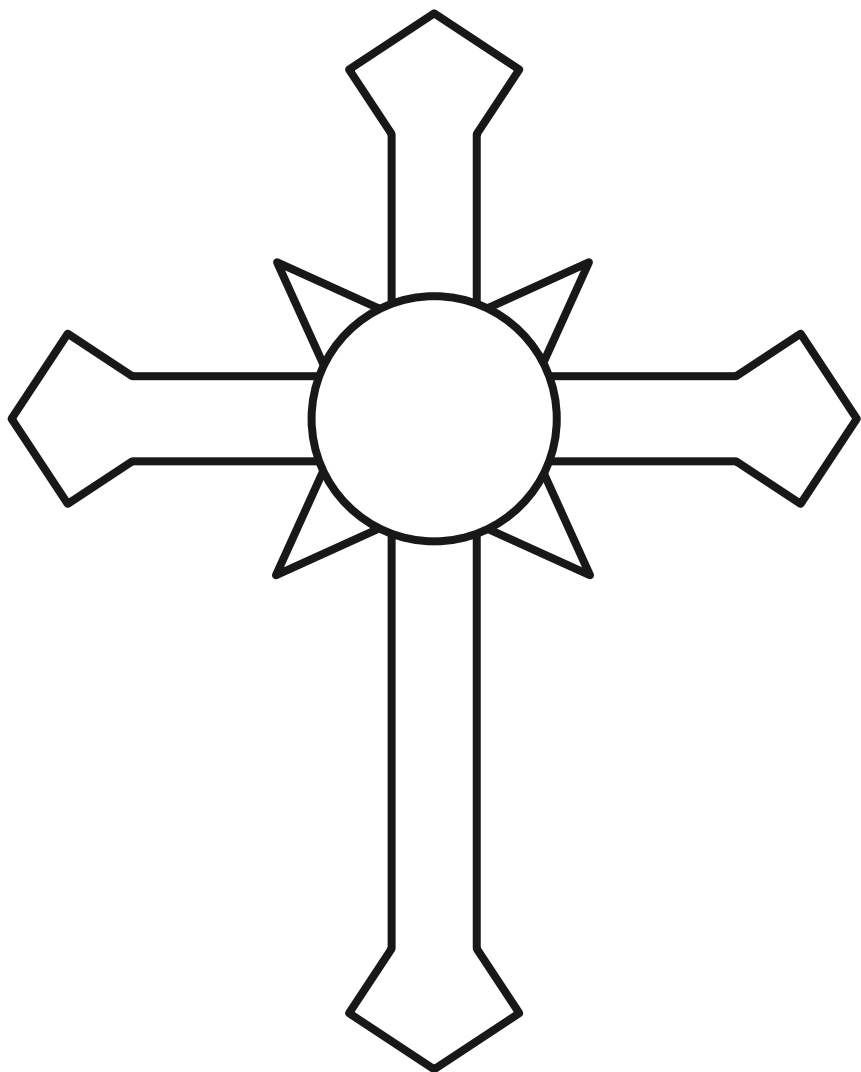


Materia Mundi

Magic-User's Handbook



Volume 2

Divine Miracles

1

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Common Prayers

Rebuke The Unholy

At-Will Curse

Rebuking undead and infernal threats is a gift that all priests learn at first level. It does not require any preparation; you simply use your action to flourish a holy symbol and save vs. Fear or Curse (your choice) to attempt to drive back every unholy creature within a 5-pace cone that is your level or lower. You may instead attempt to drive back a single creature that is higher level than you, but your saving throw is harder.

Each affected creature functionally becomes panicked for as long as you focus, even if it is normally immune to fear-based effects. If you are fifth level or higher, any affected targets with only one hit die are destroyed or banished, instead of driven back. At ninth level, affected targets with two hit dice are destroyed as well.

Sense the Divine

First Circle Divination

You use your action to close your eyes and tune into your inner senses. While you maintain focus, you can sense any objects and beings within 5 paces that are affected by divine or unholy forces.

Bless

Second Circle Blessing

You use your action to touch an adjacent creature, blessing it. While you maintain focus, each of that creature's saving throws is easier.

This miracle can also be used to create a blessed token from a piece of elemental materia - a holy symbol, holy water, blessed incense, sacramental bread, or sacred flame. Blessed tokens can be used to make a saving throws easier; incense and flame may also create a 5-pace zone of protection where undead and infernal actions are harder. Holy water and sacred flame may also be used to inflict two dice of radiant damage if thrown onto an unholy creature.

Enhance (Ability)

Third Circle Blessing

You use your action to touch an adjacent creature as you recite a brief prayer. While you maintain focus, you grant that creature a +1 bonus to the chosen ability, which immediately adjusts each of its attack and saving throws. If any other effect would grant that creature a bonus to the same ability, only the higher bonus applies. If the chosen ability has linked talents, choose one of them as you cast this spell; the bonus granted by this miracle is also applied to any task checks made with that talent. Bonuses that would reduce a talent's threshold below 2+ will instead make task checks easier.

There are six different enhance (ability) miracles, each of which is under a different Domain of Faith. Each may also be performed as a third- or fourth-circle miracle, which grant a +2 or +3 bonus instead.

Divine Guidance

Third Circle Divination

After closing your eyes and reciting a brief prayer, you receive a divine omen about the likely results of a specific course of action that you plan to take within the next 30 minutes. The answer doesn't take into account any possible supernatural circumstances that might change the outcome. The referee chooses from the following possible omens:

- Weal, for good results
- Woe, for bad results
- Weal and woe, for both good and bad
- Nothing, if results aren't good or bad

You may also use this as an extremely versatile divination ritual, which can also be used in one of two additional ways:

Find Traps - You sense the presence of any trap within 20 paces that is within line of sight. A trap, for the purpose of this miracle, includes anything that would inflict a sudden or unexpected effect you consider harmful or undesirable, which was specifically intended as such by its creator. Thus, the miracle would sense an area affected by the alarm spell, a glyph of warding, or a mechanical pit trap, but wouldn't reveal a natural weakness in the floor, unstable ceiling, or hidden sinkhole.

Dowse - You may use this ritual to find the direction of a particular object or creature. During the ritual, your divining tool becomes a compass that points in the direction of the target while you maintain focus. You must know the target to perform this miracle, or sacrifice a physical object with symbolic significance to the target and make a Lore test with a difficulty based on the relationship.

Sustenance

Fourth Circle Miracle

You conjure 1d6+1 nourishing meals, which last until consumed or until the next sunrise or sunset, along with sufficient potable water.

Divine Intervention

Fifth Circle Miracle

You contact a Celestial servant of the Divine and beg for aid, then make a hard save vs. Fear. If you succeed, and the situation is judged sufficiently dire, a powerful and unique miraculous effect manifests, with details determined by the referee.

Beauty Domain Miracles

Inspire

First Circle Blessing

Fast - you grant another creature within 5 paces a reroll on one attack throw, saving throw, or task check; the new roll is easier.

Beguile

Second Circle Curse

You attempt to beguile an intelligent mortal creature within 5 paces that makes eye contact with you or can hear your voice. If it saves vs. Trick, it knows that you attempted to manipulate its mind, and its attitude likely degrades by one step.

On a success, roll 1d6 + your Charisma and divide by 2; the target's attitude towards you improves by that many steps for as long as you maintain focus. The effect immediately ends if you do anything harmful to the beguiled creature; if they suffer injury from any other source, they also immediately make a saving throw to attempt to shake it off.

Enhance Charisma

Third Circle Blessing

You use your action to touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Charisma for as long as you maintain focus. This miracle may also be performed as a third- or fourth-circle miracle, which grant a +2 or +3 bonus instead.

Fantasy

Fourth Circle Curse

You make eye contact with a target within 5 paces that can hear and understand you, then begin describing an illusion that you wish it to perceive. While you focus, you control the target's perceptions, choosing what it can see, hear, taste, smell, and so on. Each time the target perceives or interacts with an illusory sensation that it finds in any way unpleasant or unbelievable, it may save vs. Trick to attempt to break free of the illusion. More subtle illusions are harder to break free from, while illusions that are wildly different than what the creature would otherwise be experiencing are easier.

Irresistible Dance

Fifth Circle Curse

You begin singing a song or chanting a prayer, calling those around you to join you in compelled celebration. While you use your action each turn to maintain focus, each creature within 5 paces that can hear you must save vs. Curses at the beginning of its turn to deny the effect, or it is forced to perform a comic dance as its action - shuffling, tapping its feet, and capering for the entire turn. You may move it up to its speed during its action. Each target affected by this curse cannot react to other creature's actions, and all attacks against it are easier.

Truth Domain Miracles

Holy Light

First Circle Blessing

You cause your holy symbol or the prepared prayer strip in your hand to glow with bright light out to 5 paces, and dim light out to 10 paces, for as long as you maintain focus. Undead or infernal beings caught in the bright light find that their attacks and saving throws are harder.

Reveal the Unnatural

Second Circle Divination

You touch an adjacent creature or object as you recite a brief prayer. You immediately know whether any supernatural influence is on that creature or object. If the influence is from an undead or infernal source, you know which type, as well as its approximate power level.

You may also perform this miracle in a 3-pace cone in front of yourself, briefly revealing any supernaturally hidden creature or object, but doing so will only show indistinct outlines.

Enhance Intelligence

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Intelligence for as long as you maintain focus. This miracle may also be performed as a third- or fourth-circle miracle, which grant a +2 or +3 bonus instead.

Zone of Truth

Fourth Circle Divination

You create a magical zone that guards against deception within 5 paces of you. While you maintain focus, any creature that enters the effect's area or starts its turn there must make a hard Charisma saving throw, or it can't speak a deliberate lie while within the radius, and any illusions on it are dispelled. You know whether each creature succeeds or fails on its saving throw, and each affected creature is aware of the effect and can avoid answering a question, or answer evasively, if it would normally lie.

Commune

Fifth Circle Divination

You contact a servant of the Divine and ask it a single simple yes-or-no question concerning a specific goal, event, or activity to occur within the next 7 days. You receive a correct answer if it can be made known to you. Saints aren't necessarily omniscient, so you might receive "maybe" as an answer if the question depends on as-yet-unmade decisions.

Fate Domain Miracles

Command

First Circle Curse

You make eye contact with a target within 5 paces that can both hear and understand you, then say a single imperative word such as “jump” or “quiet”. It must save vs. Trick or follow the command on its next action. Its saving throw is easy if the command is obviously harmful.

True Strike

Second Circle Divination

Fast - You touch a weapon and utter a brief prayer. The next attack throw made with that weapon before the end of the next round replaces its d20 with a ‘20’.

Divine Censure

Third Circle Curse

You choose a creature that you can see within 25 paces. While you maintain focus, this curse interferes with the target’s connection with aetheric energies; while censured, a creature may not cast spells, perform miracles, or generate other magical effects of any kind. A target with more hit dice than your own may save vs. Curse to attempt magic.

Banish the Unnatural

Fourth Circle Curse

You force a being within 5 paces that is not native to the Material Plane to make a save vs. Fear. If it fails, that being is banished to its native plane, and cannot return to the Material for one lunar month. If it succeeds, you cannot attempt this miracle against it again for one month.

Geas

Fifth Circle Curse

You force a creature that can see and hear you within 20 paces to make a saving throw vs. Curses. If they fail, you place a divine command on the target, forcing them to carry out some service or refrain from some action or course of activity while you maintain focus.

If cast as a ritual, your geas may be worded so that only a certain action or circumstance may break it. If the target fails to save, and the referee determines that the conditions are possible to fulfill, the geas becomes utterly permanent until those conditions are met - not even a remove curse miracle can break it. You cannot undo such a curse once it is done.

Freedom Domain Miracles

Calm Emotions

First Circle Blessing

You attempt to suppress strong emotions in all mortals within 5 paces of you. You can suppress any effect causing them to be beguiled, hostile, or panicked for as long as you maintain focus, and all their saving throws vs. Fear become easier.

Divine Rebuke

Second Circle Curse

Fast - You react to another creature that you can see within 20 paces as it casts a spell, miracle, or other supernatural effect, then you save vs. Curse at a difficulty equal to the effect's circle to negate it.

Enhance Dexterity

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Dexterity for as long as you maintain focus. This miracle may also be performed as a third- or fourth-circle miracle, which grant a +2 or +3 bonus instead.

Remove Curse

Fourth Circle Blessing

You touch an object or willing creature and offer a prayer of deliverance. The target may immediately make a saving throw to shrug off an ongoing effect or break a curse or other supernatural affliction affecting it. This saving throw is easy for a first-circle effect, or hard for a third-circle effect, and the target may use your save vs. Curse threshold instead of its normal saving throw threshold.

Restoration

Fifth Circle Blessing

You lay your hands on an injured, disabled, or cursed creature, praying for its afflictions to be lifted. Make a hard save vs. Curse as you pray fervently; if you perform this miracle as a ritual, you may reduce the difficulty by one step per 1,000 gp worth of sacrifices made.

On a success, you may remove one curse, disease, or poison that is affecting the creature, or heal one debilitation or maiming effect even if it is from an old injury. On a critical success, you remove one affliction, plus a number of additional afflictions equal to the number of 1,000 gp sacrifices made. If you fail, the target may not be the subject of this prayer again for one lunar month.

Life Domain Miracles

Heal Minor Wounds

First Circle Blessing

You touch a living creature, allowing it to roll one hit die and heal that many hit points. If you perform this miracle on a creature that has lost half or more of its hit points, it instead only heals one hit point.

Cure Poison or Disease

Second Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, removing one poison or disease affecting it.

Enhance Constitution

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Constitution for as long as you maintain focus. This miracle may also be performed as a third- or fourth-circle miracle, which grant a +2 or +3 bonus instead.

Heal Serious Wounds

Fourth Circle Blessing

You touch a living creature that has lost hit points. That creature rolls all of its hit dice, setting its hit points to the rolled value if that roll is higher than its current hit points, or healing one hit point if the roll isn't higher than its current hit points.

Heal Critical Wounds

Fifth Circle Blessing

You touch a living creature to immediately heal all of its hit points. It awakens if it was unconscious due to injury.

Raising the Dead

When performed as a ritual, the Revive miracle can affect the corpse of a creature that died within the last hour, rolling a hard save vs. Curse as you try to call the creature's spirit back from the afterlife. The difficulty is reduced by one step for every 10,000 gp worth of sacrifices made. If you succeed, it heals one hit die worth of hit points and returns to life. If both d20 rolls fail, the creature's corpse reanimates as an undead monster and immediately attacks the party.

If performed as a ritual with at least 3 participants, this miracle can resurrect a corpse that has been dead for up to one lunar month. Each participant in the ritual must be someone who knew the target in life; each participant must succeed in a hard save vs. Curses; if fewer participants succeed than the number of days that the target has been dead, the corpse reanimates as an undead revenant. Each participant may reduce the difficulty of their own saving throw by one step per 10,000 gp worth of sacrifices that they personally offer.

Death Domain Miracles

Cause Fear

First Circle Curse

You instill terror in every living creature within a 5-pace cone. Each target immediately saves vs. Fear or drops whatever it is holding and becomes panicked by you for as long as you maintain focus.

Speak With Dead

Second Circle Divination

You must hold a portion of a corpse, or a possession that it valued in life, as you call its ghost from the Shadow across the veil, allowing it to answer a question that you pose. Its answers are usually brief, cryptic, and repetitive.

This miracle may also be used to interact with an incorporeal undead within 5 paces of you. An intelligent ghost may attempt to resist as a save vs. Trick; if it does not or cannot resist, it must answer any questions that you pose to it while you maintain focus, and may not take other actions.

Curse Ability

Third Circle Curse

You make eye contact with a creature within 5 paces as you recite a brief prayer and choose an ability. It must save vs. curses or suffer a -1 penalty to the chosen ability while you focus, and all its task checks linked to that ability are harder. This miracle may also be performed as a third- or fourth-circle miracle, inflicting a -2 or -3 penalty instead.

Lay to Rest

Fourth Circle Curse or Blessing

You make a melee attack throw to touch an undead creature with fewer hit dice than your own. If you succeed, the creature must immediately save vs. curses or be destroyed. If its hit dice are fewer than half your own, its saving throw is harder, and a mindless undead is automatically destroyed regardless of hit dice.

This prayer may also be performed on a willing, dying creature as a blessing to free its soul into the Everafter, killing it immediately and preventing it from reincarnating or rising as any kind of undead.

Revive

Fifth Circle Blessing

You touch a creature that has died within the last 10 minutes. It is immediately restored to life at 1 hp. Any diseases that are affecting it are also cured.

War Domain Miracles

Heroism

First Circle Blessing

You may touch a willing creature and imbue them with bravery. While you maintain focus, that creature is immune to being panicked, and each of its attack throws is easier.

Smite

Second Circle Curse

Fast - You may perform this miracle as you or an adjacent ally hits with a melee weapon attack. Your weapon flares with white-hot intensity, and the attack deals +2d6 radiant damage in addition to its normal weapon damage. An undead or infernal creature suffers a critical hit if either of these damage dice roll a '6'.

If performed as a ritual, you specify a single distinguishable creature by name while blessing a melee weapon. The first time the weapon hits that creature, its damage is augmented as above.

Enhance Strength

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Strength for as long as you maintain focus. This miracle may also be performed as a third- or fourth-circle miracle, which grant a +2 or +3 bonus instead.

Shield of Faith

Fourth Circle Blessing

Fast - You may react with this miracle when a creature within 10 paces would suffer hit point damage. A radiant aura of divine energy forms around the target, granting the target 5d6 bonus hit points before damage is applied. Any leftover hit points are sustained if you maintain focus.

Divine Champion

Fifth Circle Blessing

You raise your weapon high above your head and call upon the favor of the Divine to prevail against evil. While you maintain focus, you emit bright light out to 5 paces and dim light out to 10 paces. You and all allies within 5 paces of you are immune to being panicked, all attack throws and saving throws made by those creatures are easier, and all attack throws and saving throws made by unholy beings within 10 paces of you are harder. While you maintain focus on this effect, you may cause any attack made by you or within 5 paces of you to gain all of the effects of the smite miracle.

Peace Domain Miracles

Sanctuary

First Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, warding it against attack. While you maintain focus, any creature who targets the warded creature with an attack or a harmful magic must first save vs. Fear. On a failed save, the creature loses their action. If the warded creature makes an attack, casts magic that affects an enemy, or intentionally damages a creature, the blessing ends.

Tongues

Second Circle Divination

You touch a creature, granting it the ability to understand any spoken language it hears while you maintain focus. Moreover, when the target speaks, any creature that knows at least one language and can hear the target understands what it says.

Enhance Wisdom

Third Circle Blessing

You touch a creature, giving it a +1 bonus to Wisdom for as long as you maintain focus. This miracle may also be performed as a third- or fourth-circle miracle, which grant a +2 or +3 bonus instead.

Beacon of Hope

Fourth Circle Blessing

You inspire hope in all nearby allies. While you maintain focus, all saving throws and hit die rolls of each ally within 5 paces are easier, and all allied creatures within that radius automatically succeed at any save vs. Fear.

Hallow

Fifth Circle Blessing

You touch the ground with your bare hands or feet and infuse an area up to 5 paces around it with holy power. While you maintain focus, unholy creatures can't enter the area, nor can such creatures beguile, panic, or possess creatures within it. Any creature so affected by an undead or infernal creature is no longer affected upon entering the area.

Consecrating Hallowed Ground

If cast as a ritual, the effects of the Hallow miracle do not require focus to maintain, but remain until the next sunrise or sundown. You may designate a larger space by marking the boundary with holy water, incense, or other blessed tokens, using one such token for every pace of the space's boundary. If this ritual is cast in the same place at each sunrise and sunset for a lunar month, the effects become permanent until dispelled.

Nature Domain Miracles

Protection from Elements

First Circle

You may touch a creature, granting it protection from poison, disease, and temperature extremes while you maintain focus. All fire, cold, and poison damage is halved, and any environmental effects related to temperature or toxins that would make actions harder are ignored.

Speak With Animals

Second Circle

You make eye contact with a natural animal or fey beast. You establish an empathic bond between yourself and that creature, allowing the exchange of simple concepts, emotions, and requests through wordless communication for as long as you maintain focus.

Bountiful Harvest

Third Circle

You touch an edible plant and channel vitality into it, causing it to cycle through its growing season over several seconds, immediately yielding a rich harvest sufficient to provide 1d6+1 nourishing meals.

When cast as a ritual, you may alternatively channel vitality within a specific area with long-term benefits. All plants in a half-mile radius centered on you become enriched for one year, doubling their harvest and making all Survival checks to cultivate the land easier.

Create Water

Fourth Circle

You create 1d6 gallons of potable water; enough to last a single medium creature that many weeks.

Call Storm

Fifth Circle

You begin this prayer while outdoors in a heavy storm. For as long as you maintain focus, you may use your action each round to influence the storm for 25 paces around you. If cast as a ritual, you may conjure a storm from a clear sky over the course of an hour, rolling 2d6 to determine the number of hours that the storm will last. You may also use this ritual to calm a storm in progress, dissipating it into clear skies. Two druids performing this ritual at cross-purposes within a mile of each other each make a Survival test to determine which ritual succeeds, with no net effect happening if both succeed or both fail.

Artifice Domain Miracles

Mend

First Circle

You repair a single break or tear in a damaged non-living object with a touch, such as a broken chain link, two halves of a broken key, a tear in a cloak, or a leak in a wineskin. As long as each break or tear is no larger than 1 foot in any dimension, you mend it, leaving no trace of the former damage. You may also repair one point of a weapon or armor's reduction in performance from a sundering effect. This miracle can physically repair a magic item or construct, but the blessing can't restore magic to such an object.

Recharge Magic Item

Second Circle

You can perform this miracle while holding any arcane magic item with an expended charge, then make a Science check and a Finesse check, with a difficulty based on the item's rarity; if both rolls succeed, the item regains one charge. Each time you attempt this miracle, you use one charge of materia of an element appropriate to the magic item.

Enchant Common Dweomer

Third Circle

You can brew common potions and prepare common dweomer enchantments. Each common dweomer takes up one third-circle prayer strip preparation.

Enchant Uncommon Dweomer

Fourth Circle

You can brew uncommon potions and prepare uncommon dweomer enchantments. Each uncommon dweomer takes up one fourth-circle prayer strip preparation.

Enchant Rare Dweomer

Fifth Circle

You can brew common potions and prepare rare dweomer enchantments. Each rare dweomer takes up one fifth-circle prayer strip preparation.

Divine Miracles: a Primer

Each priest has a domain of faith, which is a particular aspect of the divine that they dedicate themselves to. A priest can perform divine miracles from that domain simply by channeling that innate faith, while other miracles must be prepared. Preparing a divine miracle requires time spent in deep prayer and meditation while writing the request for that miracle out on a prayer strip, which will retain potency until the next sunrise or sunset.

Prayer Strips

A prayer strip is a small piece of pure white paper or parchment, approximately the size of an open palm, upon which a short prayer has been written in expensive ink with fine calligraphy. This prayer strip is the physical token used to perform a prepared miracle, and must be kept clean and unspoiled in order to be used for divine purposes.

If something causes you to lose a charged prayer strip before you can use it, you don't necessarily lose the magic that you invested - the Saints are not quite so fickle. As an exploration action after losing your prayer strips, you can use any available paper and writing utensils to attempt to recreate suitable tokens. So long as you show proper reverence, the original prayer strips will be consumed - wherever they are - and whatever makeshift scraps you have produced will magically transform into exact copies of the originals.

Once you have prepared a miracle into a prayer strip, you must use the strip as you perform the miracle; the sacrifices performed when you prepared it fuel the miracle. If a prayer strip miracle has a range of touch or melee, you must physically touch the prayer strip to the target, at which point it magically adheres and begins to burn away in a nimbus of holy light. If the miracle is ranged, you hold the strip up towards the target, say the first verse of the prayer aloud, and fling it at the target, at which point it magically flies from your hand to attach to the target, and then begins to glow brightly and burn away as it activates.

Prayer Scrolls

A prayer strip lasts until the next sunrise or sunset, after which it loses its divine power and must be discarded or recharged with additional prayer and sacrifice. You may choose to make sacrifices and burnt offerings worth at least 100 gp per circle while preparing a prayer strip; if you do, that prayer strip becomes supernaturally resilient, and will retain its potency indefinitely until used. Such a prayer strip can be used by any priest to perform the prepared miracle.

A non-priest may attempt to perform a miracle from a prayer scroll, but doing so takes additional time and effort. First, the non-priest must save vs. Curse, which is easy for a first-circle prayer and hard for a third-circle prayer. If they succeed, they perform the prayer properly and the miracle occurs; if they fail, the prayer scroll is consumed but a divine mishap occurs - possibly targeting the prayer at random, reversing the effect of the miracle, or some other effect chosen by the referee.

Divine Rituals

A priest's miraculous power is significantly enhanced by proper adherence to ritual. Divine rituals led by a priest of the appropriate domain allow multiple priests working in tandem, or even sufficiently devout non-priests, to each contribute to the ritual's success.

Each earnest participant in a divine ritual saves vs. Fear or Curse, even if they are not a priest. Each participant that succeeds contributes to the ritual's intended effect.

A divine ritual lasts for as long as all of its contributing participants continue to maintain focus on it. If any participant who positively contributed to the ritual breaks focus, the ritual and its associated miraculous effect immediately ends.

Any priest may perform a ritual blessing or curse from their faith's domain during the hour before dawn or sunset to cause that ritual's effects to last until the next sunrise or sunset, without anyone needing to maintain focus on it. Others may participate in the ritual as well, increasing its power and hardening it against counter-magics.

Sanctified Oaths

Many divine blessings have multiple different ritual forms, adjusting the nature of the blessing to match a special occasion. For example, various wedding ceremonies weave a Bless or Sanctuary effect into the officiating priest's sanctification of the couple's vows. Any such blessing is known as a sanctified oath.

All recipients of a sanctified oath must directly participate in the ritual sanctifying their oath, and must succeed in their save vs. Curse to contribute to the ritual. An oath must be sworn in earnest by all participants, for the oath's own sake, or it will not be sanctified by the Divine.

A properly sanctified blessing sustains itself indefinitely without focus so long as all participants continue to uphold their end of their sworn oaths. If any member breaks their oath, however, all members who participated in the ritual lose their blessing, and the participant who directly violated their oath suffers a curse proportional in strength to their original blessing. The details of this curse vary from oathbreaker to oathbreaker, but will always be ironically appropriate to the nature of their vow and violation.

Sanctified oaths are visible via identify magic and similar effects. An oath blessing appears as strands of light woven into the oathkeeper's aura, while an oathbreaker's curse appears as dark chains binding them and cutting painfully into their aura.

A priest can release another creature from a sanctified vow through a ritual of atonement, which must be performed at the same circle as the ritual that originally sanctified the vow. The creature being released must participate successfully in the ritual to be released from their vow, and must make appropriate sacrifices to demonstrate their sincerity. If successful, the oath (and its attendant blessing or curse) are nullified.

A creature may not be bound by more circles worth of sanctified oaths than their level. If they attempt to swear an oath beyond this limit, they simply fail until they can be released from one of their previous oaths.

The following are a few examples of oaths that a player character might swear. Non-priests may also swear these oaths, if they can find a sufficiently high-level priest to witness and sanctify them.

Vow of Absolute Frankness

A mortal that swears a vow of absolute frankness may never lie or intentionally mislead another, and must attempt to correct those who labor under beliefs that the oathmaker knows to be false. Once they explain the truth, however, they are under no further duty if that truth is rejected by those who hear it. While they maintain this oath, they may perform the Reveal the Unnatural miracle once per day without preparation. At sixth level, they may strengthen their vow, perpetually surrounding themselves with a Zone of Truth.

Vow of Honor

A mortal that swears a vow of honor must never allow another to suffer in their stead, and must always fight directly and honorably, choosing single combat against an evenly-matched or superior foe whenever possible. While they maintain this oath, they perpetually gain the benefits of the Heroism miracle. At fifth level, they may strengthen their vow to gain +1 Strength; at ninth level, they may strengthen their vow again to gain all the benefits of the Divine Champion miracle.

Vow of Hospitality

A mortal that swears a vow of hospitality must never refuse any stranger that asks for shelter, food, company, or protection when they have any to provide, so long as that stranger behaves civilly and does not threaten the oathmaker or anyone else under their care. While they maintain this oath, they perpetually gain the benefits of the Tongues miracle if they are second level or higher. At sixth level, they may choose to strengthen their vow, gaining the ability to perform the Sustenance miracle without preparation if another mortal asks them to share a meal. Once they perform this miracle, they may not do so again until the next sunrise or sunset.

Vow of Pacifism

A mortal that swears a vow of pacifism may not intentionally harm another mortal through their actions, and may own no weapons. They are also expected to counsel against violence in general, but they do not violate their oath by associating with warriors or those who do violence for a just cause. While they maintain this oath, they are perpetually under the protection of the Sanctuary miracle. At fifth level, they may choose to strengthen their vow, gaining the protection of the Shield of Faith miracle. The temporary hit points provided by this miracle are re-rolled the first time in each encounter that they are damaged.

Vow of Poverty

A mortal that swears a vow of poverty may never own more than a walking staff, a bowl, a prayer book, a holy symbol, and unarmored robes. Any other treasures that they find must be given away to those who need them, or given to the Church to distribute to the poor at the earliest opportunity. While they maintain this oath, they perpetually gain Protection from the Elements.

Good and Evil, Right and Wrong

The chief duty of a priest is offering moral guidance to others. As such, a priest must be an exemplar of the four cardinal virtues of justice, mercy, honor, and prudence.

Justice

A priest should encourage their companions to be honest and forthright with all their dealings, not to cheat or steal, and to obey the local authorities insofar as those authorities are themselves known to be virtuous. Conflicts between different authorities should be handled through the proper authorities whenever possible, unless doing so would create a larger miscarriage of justice.

Mercy

The Prophet was sent into the world to redeem it, and turn all minds to obedience to the Divine Principle. This offer of redemption is the most sacred tenet of the Faith, and inflicting cruelty in the name of "justice" is one of its gravest sins. Inasmuch as surrender and redemption can be offered to one's enemies, the priest and their allies must seek to do so.

Honor

A priest and their companions should face danger with courage, and should never place another mortal at risk when they could reasonably take that risk on themselves. Above all, a priest and their companions should never abuse their power and authority to gain unfair advantage over others, or use trickery and guile when a fair fight is possible.

Prudence

While justice, mercy, and honor are all important, prudence is the virtue that tempers them and seeks balance between them.

Justice that turns to cruelty or madness is no justice at all, and the genuine needs of the people and the realm must temper the principles that uphold them.

Creatures that betray a good faith offers of surrender and redemption might forfeit their right to mercy, if the benefit of the doubt would reasonably place innocents at risk.

Those that show themselves without honor similarly forfeit their right to be fought with honor, and may be dispatched expediently.

Church Dogma

Church dogma holds that the Divine Principle lays out an ideal course for man to follow, but that greed and vengeance and fear tempt men to disobey; that the Prophet, by fully accepting their role as the Lamb of Sacrifice, was made one with the Will of the Divine, thus planting the seed for the Kingdom of Heaven which cleanses the sins of the world, and that obedience to the Divine Principle, as demonstrated by the Lamb of Sacrifice, allows men to participate in the communion of the Divine Spirit, by which the Kingdom of Heaven is built and eternally improved.

Sects and Heresies

Various groups show themselves perfectly capable of channeling Divine magic, whether or not they agree with the Church's dogma. Some of these sects are considered to be in catholic communion with the Church, while others are considered heretical. Nevertheless, a priests of the Divine must never sanction the following acts:

- Blood sacrifice of an intelligent mortal
- Cruelty or torture towards any being capable of feeling
- Slavery or imprisonment lasting more than 7 years, including maintaining willing servitude under false pretenses
- Murder, including deliberately depriving a mortal of their necessities
- Gross and deliberate injustice wrought for personal gain

Sins and Atonement

A priest that fails to live up to the ideals of the four cardinal virtues, or who commits even graver sins against the Divine Principle, may find themselves unable to perform miracles until they atone for their sins. The process of atonement depends upon the sins committed, but invariably involves confessing those sins to a higher-ranking priest, then making an honest effort to right whatever wrongs can be undone, and finally a heartfelt commitment to avoid similar transgressions in the future. A priest who attempts to atone under false premises will find themselves completely cut off from their granted powers until they align their beliefs and behavior with the Divine.

Ghosts and The Underworld

Another duty of a priest is maintaining the boundary between the living material world and the underworld of the dead. Angry ghosts require appeasement and guidance to give up their mortal passions and move on to the afterlife; convincing them to do so falls upon the clergy. Failure to fulfill that duty in a timely fashion can lead to an unappeased ghost becoming one of the undead; over an extended time, accumulations of necromantic energy can even lead to the Shadow of the underworld bleeding over into the material.

Like Faerie, the Shadow is a liminal realm between the Underworld proper and the Material Plane, whose distance waxes and wanes with the phases of the moon. During the three days around the full moon, travel into and out of the Shadow is harder, while during the three days around the new moon, travel between Shadow and the Material is easier. Both of these times create a lot of work for priests, as the new moon permits ghosts and the undead to manifest, while the full moon tends to trap them on whichever side of the veil they find themselves on.

Whenever a living being dies, its death will emit a burst of Aetheric energy which 'imprints' upon the Shadow, creating a pale copy of its consciousness called a 'ghost'. This imprint might be anything from a vague impression of the being it once was, to a fully formed visage and personality, capable of carrying out the wishes of the living being it was copied from. Stronger ghosts contain most of the memories and personalities of the creature that they echo; intelligent beings, such as sapient mortals, produce a ghost that is nearly identical to its mortal form. Even so, most ghosts arrive in the Shadow disoriented and confused. If the body that spawned a ghost is restored to life, that ghost will be pulled irresistibly to it, restoring its mind and memories and adding the ghost's memories to its own.

Most ghosts immediately leave the Shadow realm for the Everafter, the collection of afterlives that serve as the "eternal reward" for the once-living. The church maintains that those in catholic communion will reach heaven, an Everafter where they are united with the Divine Principle and become saints.

Saints

Ghosts that have been properly appeased and sanctified move onto the afterlife, where they are judged for their deeds in life and united with the divine. Most religion in the world treats sacred ancestors, called saints, as intermediaries between the Divine and living mortals. It is part of a priest's duties to serve as an ambassador and messenger between the saints and the living, reminding both of their duties to the other.

Numina

Other Saints, called Numina, were never living mortals at all; these Saints are Fair Folk or even Baalim that were offered redemption and communion into the catholic Faith, and accepted. These beings are considered just as saintly as the martyred dead; most such Saints concern themselves with the protection of a particular area within the Material world, and its corresponding echoes within Faerie.

Angelic Manifestation

One of the more common responses to a priest's prayers for divine intervention is the manifestation of a Saint or Numen. Manifestation allows the saint or numen to form a physical body, called an 'angel', to affect the material world. An angel will manifest adjacent to the priest as they pray, and will act to aid them directly, with the referee controlling the angel's actions. An angel manifests as a 5 hd creature with five 'faith', which it can use to perform miracles. The Saint's angelic body dissipates once either its hit points or its faith are depleted, or at the next sunrise or sunset.

The Unholy

Undead and infernal creatures together make up the unholy - creatures so inimical to the divine order that they must be defied and destroyed on sight. Particularly savage fair folk might also qualify as unholy, depending on their natures.

Mortal beings are never unholy, unless they are currently being possessed or directly controlled by an unholy supernatural being. Unholiness is not mere wickedness, but is an intrinsic nature that is deeply inimical to both the divine and primal orders. Countering the efforts of the unholy is the primary reason that the Divine imbues priests and sends them forth into the world.